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whoami

Habtamu Asefa

Full-Stack AI Engineer / AI Product Engineer / ships end-to-end

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in linkedin.com/in/habtamu-asefa ↗ github.com/habasefa ⚡ npm/react-native-ajora

// summary

Full-Stack AI Engineer who ships AI-native products end-to-end — from **RAG, agents, and retrieval** through mobile UX, backend, and cloud deployment. Founder of **PrepX**, an AI tutoring app (1,000+ users, 250 MAU), and **Temaribet**, a tutoring marketplace scaled to 4,000+ tutors and 500+ families. Author of **react-native-ajora**, an open-source agent-UI library with 6,100+ npm downloads. Proven remote delivery for US/EU startups.

technical_skills

— 8 domains

AI engineering	LLM agents, RAG, tool calling, prompt engineering, evals, streaming AI UX, model routing (OpenRouter)
Search & retrieval	Qdrant (vector), Typesense (full-text), hybrid search, textbook & curriculum indexing
Backend	NestJS, FastAPI, Node.js, Express, REST APIs, auth, notification pipelines
Mobile	React Native, Expo, EAS Build, offline-first architecture, SSE streaming interfaces
Agent tooling	Agno, Mastra, AG-UI / CopilotKit patterns, server-side tool execution
Databases	PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite
DevOps	AWS EC2, Debian Linux, Nginx, PM2, Certbot, SSL/DNS, production debugging
Languages	TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL

experience

— git log --author=habtamu

2024 — Present

Addis Ababa, ET

React NativeNestJSFastAPIQdrantTypesenseRAGOpenRouter

Founder & Lead Engineer

PrepX — AI-native learning platform

Textbook-grounded AI tutoring with offline-first mobile UX for Ethiopian high-school students.

- Built and shipped the full **React Native (Expo)** app and AI tutoring pipeline; grew to **1,000+ installs, 250 MAU, 5★**, and launched subscription monetization with a 3-person team.
- Designed a **hybrid RAG** system (**Qdrant** vector + **Typesense** full-text) for textbook-grounded answers, kept **model-agnostic** across Gemini, GPT, Claude, and open models via OpenRouter.
- Modeled a **self-referential curriculum graph** across 4 grades, 6 subjects, and 12 years of national exams — **~229K questions, 13.5K quizzes, 5.75K worksheets, 1.86K flashcard sets**.
- Built backend services with NestJS, FastAPI, and PostgreSQL powering chat, retrieval, content workflows, notifications, and live competitions.

2019 — 2025

Addis Ababa, ET

MarketplaceOperationsEdTech

Founder

Temaribet — tutoring marketplace

In-home tutoring marketplace connecting families with vetted college-student tutors.

- Built and operated a two-sided marketplace to **4,000+ tutors and 500+ families** (started as a freshman), owning onboarding, matching, operations, and product strategy.
- Selected into **Reach for Change** and **Orbit Innovation Hub** accelerators (backed by the IKEA Foundation & Mastercard Foundation); awarded grant funding and won a startup pitch competition.

2023 — Present

Remote · US / EU

React Native

Node.js

NestJS

MongoDB

AWS EC2

Nginx

Full-Stack / Mobile Engineer

Freelance & Agency — US / EU clients

Production mobile and web applications for international startups and agency teams.

- **Dymnd (Chicago startup):** shipped production React Native features used by **100+ users** over a multi-month paid engagement — rebuilt timezone-sensitive habit logic and fixed OTP, consent, keyboard, and navigation defects to improve reliability.
- Maintained and upgraded a **US bar-exam prep platform** — backend/infra work (Node.js, AWS EC2, Nginx, Certbot) plus production bug fixes and stability improvements.
- Owned end-to-end delivery across both: **EAS** builds, app-store releases, server deployment, and live production debugging.

2024 — Present

React Native

SSE

Gemini

npm

react-native-ajora — open-source AI agent UI for React Native

- Authored "the most complete AI agent UI for React Native" — **6,100+ npm downloads, 19 GitHub stars**. Ports AG-UI / CopilotKit agentic patterns to mobile: **SSE** streaming, tool calls, sources, threads, and server-side tool execution with Gemini.

Ongoing

TypeScript

React Native

Python

Open-source contributions

- Contributor to **Expensify's** production React Native app; **49 public repos** spanning AI, mobile, and backend.

2024

Embedded

Sensors

Biomedical

UlcerGuard — diabetic foot-ulcer prevention footwear

AAU / AAiT thesis

- Built an embedded pressure-sensing footwear prototype detecting high-pressure foot regions to help prevent diabetic foot ulcers — biomedical analysis, sensors, and hardware prototyping.

education

BSc, Biomedical Engineering

Addis Ababa University / AAiT · 2024

Thesis: **UlcerGuard** — pressure-sensing footwear for diabetic foot-ulcer prevention.

achievements

- § Scaled **Temaribet** to 4,000+ tutors & 500+ families; selected into **Reach for Change & Orbit Innovation Hub**.
- § Shipped **PrepX** to 1,000+ installs, 250 MAU, 5★ with a 3-person team.
- § Authored **react-native-ajora** — 6,100+ npm downloads, 19★.
- § Delivered production software for US/EU startups across mobile, backend & infra.

target_roles

➤ Full-Stack AI Engineer · AI Product Engineer · Applied AI Engineer · AI Engineer · Product Engineer @ AI-native startups